

Around 1810, Beethoven courted Therese Malfatti, an Austrian musician and daughter of one of the composer's doctors. It was probably for her that he wrote the piano piece confusingly known as Für Elise. This infatuation also came to nothing.



THE MALFATTI FAMILY

Therese Malfatti, shown seated at the piano surrounded by her family, was the object of Beethoven's affection around 1810. Some historians speculate that he proposed marriage to her.

A peak of creativity

Between 1802 and 1812, Beethoven produced a stream of masterpieces that revealed his creative ambition. He never broke with the established Classical forms of the late 18th century—sonatas and rondos, symphonies and string quartets—but stretched them beyond all previous emotional and formal limits. His Third Symphony, the